

Michael T. Baker

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Office of Economic and Manpower Analysis (OEMA)
Department of Social Sciences
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Biography

Major Michael Baker is an Assistant Professor of Economics in the Department of Social Sciences (SOSH) and a Research Analyst in the Office of Economic and Manpower Analysis (OEMA). He joined the economics faculty in SOSH in the Fall of 2021 and earned his Ph.D. in Economics from the University of Notre Dame in 2022. As the lead analyst in the Army Marketing Research Cell, he conducts research and data analysis supporting Army marketing and recruiting efforts. Prior to graduate school, Michael served as an Armor officer for eight years in the 4th Infantry Division (Fort Carson, Colorado) and the 1st Infantry Division (Fort Riley, Kansas) with roles including Scout Platoon Leader, Troop Executive Officer, Squadron Logistics Officer (S-4), Assistant Brigade Operations Officer (S-3), and Troop Commander. His deployments include Afghanistan (2011), Kuwait (2013), and South Korea (2016-2017). His military training includes Airborne School, Armor Officer Basic Course, Army Reconnaissance Course, Infantry Mortar Leader Course, Maneuver Captain's Career Course, Cavalry Leader's Course, and Ranger School. Michael and his wife Heather have four children: Ella, Violet, Lily, and Caleb.

Education

Ph.D., Economics, University of Notre Dame, Notre Dame, Indiana, 2022.

Dissertation Committee: Kasey Buckles (Chair), Kirsten Cornelson, William Evans, Ethan Lieber

B.S., Economics and Spanish, United States Military Academy, West Point, New York, 2010.

Positions

United States Military Academy, West Point, NY

Research Analyst, Office of Economic and Manpower Analysis, 2022-present

Assistant Professor, Department of Social Sciences, 2022-present

Instructor of Economics, Department of Social Sciences, 2021-2022

Research

Fields: Applied Microeconomics, Labor Economics, Public Economics

Teaching Experience

Intermediate Microeconomics, West Point (Six Semesters: Fall 2021 – Spring 2024)

Econometrics I, West Point (One Semester: Spring 2025)

Professional Memberships

American Economic Association, Society of Labor Economists, Association of Christian Economists